URIAH RAFFER

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

IT professional with hands-on experience in the design, configuration, operation, and maintenance of Windows and Linux servers across cloud and virtualized environments. Recommends cost-effective, highly available solutions, builds with Terraform and Ansible, automates patching with PowerShell and Bash, and monitors with CloudWatch, CloudTrail, and Microsoft tooling. B.S. in Network Engineering and Security; CompTIA A+, Network+, Security+, Cloud+.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

B.S. Network Engineering and Security, Western Governors University | Conferred October 2025

CompTIA A+ · Network+ · Security+ · Cloud+ | ITIL 4 Foundation | LPI Linux Essentials

EXPERIENCE

Cybersecurity Analyst (Intern), Log(N) Pacific (Remote) Feb 2026 - Present

Structured, hands-on cybersecurity internship in lab and simulated enterprise environments (Azure, Tenable, Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint).

- Ran authenticated vulnerability and compliance scans with Tenable across Windows 10/11, Windows Server, and Linux VMs in Microsoft Azure, then remediated findings with PowerShell scripts.
- Eliminated every critical-severity finding and cut total findings by roughly 90% (30 down to 3) across remediation cycles, verifying each fix with a follow-up scan.
- Hardened systems by enabling SMB signing, requiring RDP Network Level Authentication, restoring LAN Manager authentication to secure defaults, and updating outdated software.
- Investigated inconsistent scan results and confirmed a recurring SQLite finding as a false positive by searching the host for SQLite binaries, avoiding an unnecessary change.
- Monitored endpoint health with Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and built Microsoft Sentinel dashboards with KQL queries to surface logon failures and malicious traffic.
- Eliminated password-based brute-force exposure on a public-facing host by reconfiguring SSH for key-only authentication and disabling password login.

PROJECTS

- **Highly Available AWS Infrastructure (aws-ha-infra).** Designed and built a two-availability-zone AWS server environment with Terraform. Evaluated managed NAT Gateway versus self-managed NAT instances and recommended the cost-effective option, adding an EventBridge and Lambda self-healing route path, a Multi-AZ PostgreSQL database, SSM-only access, and CloudWatch and CloudTrail monitoring. Executed a multi-scenario failure test plan to validate recovery (~149s avg) and documented the architecture.
- **AWS Provisioning and Configuration (terraform-aws, ansible).** Provisioned and configured a VPC with bastion and NAT using Terraform, and installed, configured, and maintained private Linux server instances with Ansible dynamic inventory, playbooks, and Tailscale enrollment secured with Ansible Vault.
- **Linux Homelab and Patch Automation.** Operate a self-managed Proxmox lab hosting two Pi-hole DNS servers and a pfSense firewall used as a Tailscale exit node and subnet router. Automated Linux patching with a Bash update script (aliased 'up') alongside daily unattended-upgrades.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Servers & OS: Windows Server, Windows 10/11, Linux (Ubuntu/Debian), Active Directory, DNS/DHCP, RDP/SSH, AWS SSM

Infrastructure & Cloud: AWS (VPC, EC2, RDS, IAM, Auto Scaling, CloudWatch, CloudTrail), Terraform, Proxmox, Hyper-V, VMware

Automation & Scripting: PowerShell, Bash, Ansible, Git / GitHub

Security & Operations: patch management, backup & recovery, high availability, Tenable, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Microsoft Sentinel, KQL, DISA STIG, pfSense, Tailscale